Intel is one the biggest contributors to open source technology. It is an important member of The Linux Foundation, and is one of the most significant contributors to the Linux kernel as well. But when the company designed its latest platform, Clover Trail, it chose Windows over Android or Linux. This move generated a broad range of reactions within the community, and people have begun to think that Intel is opting out of Linux and open source technology. ***Diksha P Gupta*** from ***OpenSource For You*** caught up with ***Narendra Bhandari, director, Intel Software and Services Group, Intel South Asia***, to understand the company's strategy on open source technology, its initiatives for developers in India, and the idea behind leaving Linux while designing Clover Trail. Excerpts:

Q What is Intel's strategy around open source technology?

The world knows that Intel is one of the major contributors to the Linux kernel. We contribute in a major way to Android as well. In fact, we are putting in a lot of energy into Android, given the fact that the platform is getting increasingly popular these days. I think our contribution to open source projects speaks volumes about our ideology around open source technology.

Q Does Intel do Android-related development in the Indian R&D facility as well?

Not for the base platform, but in cases where we take the platform and make it available for devices, like the Lava Xolo phone that was released recently, we work to customise it. The development is basically split between multiple sites. The Indian facility also has an important role to play in that.

Q How does Intel view the development of open source technology in India?

Overall, our strategy with open source has been pretty clear for almost 10-15 years. We are continuously investing in the base of open source like the kernel and all the other layers around it. We are a significant contributor to it. We try to push as many tools as we can on all environments, as much as possible. The community, from an application perspective, also has access to a lot of our technologies online. We have given the community SDKs, tools and we continuously update these with all the platform changes that happen.

We drive a strategy where the developers write for multiple OS platforms including the open source distributions. Our objective is to get them as much benefit from the hardware angle as well. For example, if they are writing for a particular OS with Intel architecture, there are multiple libraries and multiple layers available, which are optimised for our architecture and the developers can take advantage of that. More specifically in India, I think, from a developer programme perspective, we go across to the developers' hot-spots in the country, provide them the access and get them the information. As you are aware, the community is based on a self-driven model. People decide what they want to do and how they want to contribute as individuals and organisations. We provide the productivity tools so that they can go and contribute. I don't track how much contribution has gone from one country or the other. The community doesn't necessarily record any such details anywhere in the world. It is primarily focused on contribution.

> There are certain very clear trends in the developers' community of the country. If you look at the last three-four years, the contributions from India in the form of applications for a variety of platforms and a variety of OSs have definitely increased manifold.

Q What is your opinion about the Indian market and how does Intel plan to grow in this open source technology market?

We broadly look at the developers' base in the country. There are certain very clear trends in the developers' community of the country. If you look at the last three-four years, the contributions from India in the form of applications for a variety of platforms and a variety of OSs have definitely increased manifold. Three to four years ago, the interest in our developer programmes came mainly from people probably doing services or a small set of applications. We are now seeing a shift where a lot more people are trying to build intellectual property, which can be in the form of a game, a business application, something that makes it easy for consumers to educate themselves, something which could increase their productivity or something which could be just pure fun. What we are seeing is a pretty significant contribution from the developers based in India. Many of them use different components of technologies from across the ecosystem and the community. So, if you bring those two elements together, I think it is relatively safe to assume that there is a lot of usage and interest in what is available in open source for the developers.

The other factor that you think about in today's environment is the turn-around time for applications or the cycle time for applications—to be conceptualised, built